

Redmi Note 13 Pro+ 5G

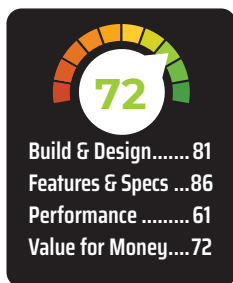
A well-rounded phone with an age-old flaw

The renowned Redmi Note series from Xiaomi has consistently brought premium features to the masses in India at an affordable price. And this year is no exception. The Redmi Note 13 series ushered in the New Year's with a couple of class-leading features, a brand-new design language, and impressive specifications. I got the top-end Redmi Note 13 Pro+ 5G for review and was immediately floored by the design language. The favourable first impression lingered as I browsed through the high-end specifications. Upon testing, there were many things I loved about this new phone; but some issues surfaced too. Priced at ₹31,999, it competes against some heavyweights in the segment including the iQOO Neo 7 Pro, OnePlus Nord 3, and Moto Edge 40. Let's delve into the detailed review of the Redmi Note 13 Pro+ 5G to find out if it's worth your dough.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Redmi Note 13 Pro+ 5G is a svelte smartphone with a distinctive design. The vegan leather rear panel features a colour block design with different pastel purple, blue and green hues adorning the back. This is the Fusion Purple colour variant, where the design is most prominent. It sets itself apart from the competition with its unconventional yet stylish looks. The coloured blocks each house a particular component or logo – the leftmost one houses the triple camera stack, the top right one features the dual LED flash, and the one below it has the Redmi branding. The bottom-most one keeps it simple with just a 5G logo.

The phone is quite slim and feels comfortable to hold due to its curved



front and back panels. However, it is not as lightweight as the Moto Edge 40 which weighs merely 171 g. Either way, the Redmi Note 13 Pro+ looks streamlined and elegant for the price. The frame is made of plastic but looks deceptively like aluminium – lending it a more premium look. The buttons are nice and tactile, but not to a distasteful degree.

On the front, the curved display looks very premium and elegant. The bezels are pretty slim with the phone sporting an 89.7 per cent screen-to-body ratio. One of the best features of the phone is its IP68 dust and water resistance rating; something only the Moto Edge 40 also offers at this price point.

DISPLAY

Xiaomi went all out with the display of the Redmi Note 13 Pro+. The phone is equipped with a 6.67-inch AMOLED panel with 1.5K resolution and 120 Hz refresh rate. Not just that, it comes with

both Dolby Vision and HDR10+ support and a claimed peak brightness of 1,800 nits! Add to that, Gorilla Glass Victus protection and this is the best-specced display in this price range.

The display is extremely vibrant and crisp – viewing angles are fantastic. I got a reading of 1,400+ nits in our brightness test, so there are no issues in viewing the display even under harsh sunlight. HDR content looks fantastic with excellent colours and great detail. The phone supports 68 billion+ colours, the highest in this segment. Furthermore, it also sports 1,920 Hz PWM dimming, meaning it is relatively safe for your eyes even in low light. The phone also houses Dolby Atmos-enabled stereo speakers, however, I found them to be a tad too soft. You'd be better off using earphones.

PERFORMANCE

With blazing-fast competitors such as the iQOO Neo 7 Pro and OnePlus Nord 3, the Redmi Note 13 Pro+ has its work cut out for it in the performance section. Regrettably, the Redmi Note 13 Pro+ doesn't match the raw power these competitors offer. The phone houses the MediaTek Dimensity 7200-Ultra chipset with 8/12 GB of LPDDR5 RAM and 256/512 GB of UFS 3.1 storage. The Dimensity 7200-Ultra has a maximum clock speed of 2.85 GHz, which is significantly lower than the processors in the iQOO Neo 7 Pro and OnePlus Nord 3.

As expected, the Redmi Note 13 Pro+ 5G doesn't fare exceedingly well in synthetic benchmarks. The phone's scores in AnTuTu and GeekBench are soundly defeated by the Snapdragon 8+ Gen 1 SoC in the iQOO Neo 7 Pro and the Dimensity 9000 SoC in the OnePlus Nord 3. However, the phone does manage to beat the Motorola Edge 40 in AnTuTu only to lose to it in GeekBench Multi-Core later. It does manage to pull off a decent PCMark Work score of 11,983 though.

In GPU tests, the phone refused to run our usual set of benchmarks including 3D Mark and GFXBench. So, I switched over to testing gaming in real